全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 23 單元 | 科技與通訊 · Technology & Communication

An Email to Grandpa about His Old Typewriter

寫給爺爺的一封信：關於他的老打字機

Dear Grandpa, thank you for the old typewriter you sent me last week. When the parcel arrived, Mom could not stop smiling, because it was the same machine she used to write her college essays on. I have cleaned every key, and it still works perfectly. Pressing the keys feels completely different from tapping on a keyboard; each letter makes a satisfying click, and there is no delete button, so I have to think before I type!

You asked how my new laptop is going. Honestly, it took me a whole afternoon to install the software I needed for school. The Wi-Fi connection in my room is weak, so I had to sit next to the router in the living room, plugged into the wall socket because the battery runs out so quickly. The school now puts every assignment on a digital platform, and we are expected to upload a file before midnight. If the signal drops at 11:59, the version you were working on is simply gone. That has happened to me twice.

Still, I know technology has made many things easier. I can browse the library catalog from my phone, attach a photo of my homework to a message, and connect with my cousins in Canada through a video call. Dad says you once sent a telegram to Grandma to ask her out, and it cost you a week's pocket money. These days a text costs nothing, but maybe that is why people do not choose their words as carefully.

I have attached a photo of the typewriter sitting next to my laptop. The old and the new look good together, don't they? I will bring it with me when we visit during the Mid-Autumn Festival, and you can teach me how to change the ribbon. Love, Yu-ting

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
typewriter	*n.*	打字機	My grandmother still keeps her typewriter in the study. 我奶奶還把她的打字機放在書房裡。
parcel	*n.*	包裹	The post office called to say my parcel had arrived. 郵局打電話來說我的包裹到了。

keyboard	*n.*	鍵盤	Some keys on my keyboard stopped working after I spilled tea on it. 我把茶灑在鍵盤上之後，有幾個鍵就壞了。
delete	*v.*	刪除	Be careful not to delete the wrong file. 小心不要刪錯檔案。
install	*v.*	安裝	It only takes a minute to install the app on your phone. 在手機上安裝這個應用程式只要一分鐘。
software	*n.*	軟體	The school bought new software for teaching math. 學校買了新的數學教學軟體。
connection	*n.*	連線；連接	The video kept stopping because of the poor connection. 因為連線不好，影片一直停頓。
socket	*n.*	插座	There is no free socket in this cafe to charge my phone. 這間咖啡店沒有空的插座可以幫我的手機充電。
digital	*adj.*	數位的	Most students now read digital textbooks on tablets. 現在大多數學生都在平板上閱讀數位教科書。
signal	*n.*	訊號	There is no phone signal inside the mountain tunnel. 山區隧道裡沒有手機訊號。

片語 Phrases

run out	用完；耗盡	My phone battery always runs out before lunch. 我的手機電池總是在午餐前就沒電。
used to + V	過去常常…	We used to play basketball every Sunday morning. 我們以前每個星期天早上都會打籃球。
ask (someone) out	邀請某人約會	He finally found the courage to ask her out. 他終於鼓起勇氣約她出去。

文法與句型 Grammar

It + takes / took + sb + 時間 + to + V

此句型表示「某人花了多少時間做某事」，it 是虛主詞，真正的主詞是後面的不定詞片語。文中 it took me a whole afternoon to install the software 即為此用法。

It took us two hours to finish the puzzle.

我們花了兩個小時才完成這幅拼圖。

S + be + expected + to + V

be expected to 是被動語態，意思是「被要求、被期望做某事」，常用於說明規定或他人的期待。文中 we are expected to upload a file before midnight 表示學校規定必須在午夜前上傳。

All students are expected to wear uniforms on Monday.

所有學生星期一都必須穿制服。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。